

YOUNG'S YARNS

The Philadelphia National League baseball club is the first to launch spring training Friday when the advance band of Phillies moves into the club's Florida base at Clearwater, Fla. The Chicago Cubs will be the first of the National Leaguers to start the ball rolling in Arizona, starting Feb. 12 at Mesa, but here locally, interest centers in the Pittsburgh operation, since a Bloomington lad is one of the 40 hands reporting to Bobby Bragan at Fort Myers this month.

"This is the big chance for me and I'm going to give it everything I have. They'll have to throw me out to get rid of me." The speaker was Curtis Raydon, only son of the Rufus Raydon's, 1112 Beechwood, who was originally signed by the Braves for a bonus of \$18,500 but figured in the big trade made by the Bucs and Braves three years ago. The husky and good looking youngster who just celebrated his 22nd birthday is one of the 40 men on the Pirate roster with orders to be on the job at Fort Myers Feb. 25.

He is one of the brighter prospects on the Pittsburgh staff and is eager to make the grade in the majors after a successful season at Hollywood, Calif. in the PCL where he was optioned for more minor league training last spring.

"If I were a lefthander my chances would be better," Curt said "and if I'm not ready for the Pirates, I'll take further seasoning in the minors but I feel this is my big chance and I'm going to give it all I've got everything I've got."

Raydon did not even get into a ball game the first year he signed but he had the benefit of a lot of coaching from one of the wisest old heads in the game—Bob Coleman, then managing Evansville, a Brave farm club. Then two successful seasons at Jacksonville, Fla. followed and the next year he was at New Orleans, where he credits Andy Cohen with being a real help to him. He was good enough to move up to Hollywood last year and had a 10-10 record in the Class AAA league despite the fact that he suffered a serious foot injury in getting off the rubber one day last summer, that set him back a great deal.

What type of pitcher is he?

"I guess you'd say I'm a fast ball pitcher but I have also mastered a curve that I did not have when I was pitching for BHS and in the Municipal league."

"Cohen helped me a lot with my curve at New Orleans."

"I have never monkeyed with the slider or sinker," Raydon added.

Two of Curt's teammates at Hollywood will also be in the Pittsburgh party, Daniels and Witt, two Californians, both of whom he rates fine prospects.

The Pirates have a lot of fine material, and their big problem is a catcher, who measures up to National League standards and, of course, that may come in a deal sometime before the major league season opens.

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